

Promises and Pressure: Evidence on the Table

承诺与压力：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The evidence meeting had a different shape **since** the survey had been rewritten. **One measure** replaced twelve: **whether** a person could find, in **one** minute, the thing they came for. “**When** the number is smaller **than** the argument, the argument wins,” Maya said. “Until we can **stay** small and honest, we should not grow.”

They pinned a chart to the **retreat** wall and compared two households in the **southwest**: **one** with a car and a **reliable** piano teacher, **one** with a **dependent** grandmother and four bicycles. The rate of **attendance** was the same; the **sadness** was not. “**Apparently** that is called a **clash** of measures,” Lin wrote. “Really it is a **clash** of lives.”

A **parental** question on the committee asked **whether** the project could **remain** neutral, and the **verbal** answer was easy. “**Communication** is not a **crowd**,” the **enthusiast** with the **violin** said. “It is a **dialog**.” Her **singular** habit of speaking in the present tense had already changed the room, and the change **involved** the **status** of every volunteer.

A **skinny** boy in worn **clothing** brought a **pillow** and a **pencil** to the **gathering** and asked to **stay**. “Hand me the list,” he said. “I will check **one** entry.” They allowed him to **isolate** three errors in an hour, and not **one** of them was small. “Your idea is a **conjunction**,” he said, “not a sentence.”

A **calculating** visitor from the city office asked **whether** the project could be utilized by anyone else. “That is the whole reason it exists,” Maya said. “Keep the till open.” Her confident **front** concealed a real problem: an **encounter** with a **nude** statue in the art building had produced the best photograph of the year, and no data at all. “Put it on the wall anyway,” she said. They could see where the argument was going, and their very assumption that a number could settle it was the problem. Much of the analysis expected a clean answer, and none was there. The **human relationship** behind every number was the part no table could **confirm**; a **herd** of students in the corridor was not a **relation**, and a photograph was not a measurement.

中文翻译

证据会议的样子和以往不同，因为调查已经被重写。一项指标取代了十二项：一个人能否在一分钟内找到他来的目的。“当数字比论证小的时候，赢的是论证，”曼雅说，“在我们能够既小又诚实之前，我们不该长大。”

他们把一张图表钉在休养所的墙上，比较西南部的两户人家：一户有汽车和一位可靠的钢琴老师，另一户有一位需要照料的祖母和四辆自行车。出席率是一样的，悲伤却不一样。“据说这叫指标的冲突，”林伟写道，“其实这是生活的冲突。”

委员会里一位父母辈的人问，这个项目能否保持中立，口头上的回答很容易。“交流不是人群，”那位带小提琴的热心者说，“它是一场对话。”她只用现在时说话的这个独特习惯已经改变了房间，而这个改变牵涉到每位志愿者的地位。

一个穿着破旧衣服的瘦男孩带着一只枕头和一支铅笔来到聚会，要求留下。“把名单递给我，”他说，“我来核对一条。”他们允许他在一小时内孤立出三个错误，而其中没有一个是小的。“你的想法是一个连词，”他说，“不是一个句子。”

市政办公室一位精于算计的来访者问，这个项目能否被别人利用。“这正是它存在的全部理由，”曼雅说，“把柜台开着。”她自信的外表掩盖了一个真实的难题：在艺术楼里与一座裸体雕像的一次邂逅，产出了全年最好的一张照片，却没有任何数据。“还是把它挂到墙上吧，”她说。他们看得出这场论证正走向哪里，而他们那个“一个数字就能解决它”的假设本身就是问题。大部分分析都期待一个干净的答案，而一个都没有。每个数字背后的人际关系是任何表格都无法确认的部分；走廊里的一群学生不是一种关系，而一张照片也不是一次测量。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
one wʌn POS: n	n. 一(个); pron. 一, 任何人; num. 一, 一个; a. 一致的, 完整的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the smallest whole number or a numeral representing this number; n. a single person or thing; s. used of a s...
when hwen POS: conj	conj. 当...的时候; adv. 何时, 什么时候; pron. 什么时候; n. 时间 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. At what time; -- used interrogatively.; adv. At what time; at, during, or after the time that; at or; j...
than ðæn POS: conj	conj. 比, 除...外; prep. 比 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: conj. A particle expressing comparison, used after certain; adjectives and adverbs which express comparison...
since sɪns POS: prep	prep. 自...以后, 自...以来; adv. 自那时以后; conj. 既然, 自...以后, 自...以来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: adv. From a definite past time until now; as, he went a month; ago, and I have not seen him since.; adv. In...
whether 'hweðə POS: conj	conj. 是否, 不论; pron. 两个中的哪一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. Which (of two); which one (of two); -- used; interrogatively and relatively.; conj. In case; if; -- us...
remain rɪ'meɪn POS: vi	vi. 保持, 逗留, 剩余; [法] 停留, 居住, 继续 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be left; of persons, questions, problems, results, evidence, etc.
human 'hju:mən POS: n	n. 人, 人类; a. 人类的, 似人类的, 人性的, 有同情心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characteristic of humanity; a. relating to a person; a. having human form or attributes as opposed to those...
stay steɪ POS: n	n. 停留, 逗留, 制止, 延缓, 停止, 支柱, 支撑物, 支索; vt. 制止, 延缓, 坚持, 支持, 支撑, 用支索固定; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. continuing or remaining in a place or state; n. a judicial order forbidding some action until an event occur...
relationship rɪ'leɪʃnʃɪp POS: n	n. 关系, 关联; [医] 关系 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a relation between people; ('relationship' is often used where 'relation' would serve, as in 'the relation'...
relation rɪ'leɪʃən POS: n	n. 关系, 联系, 叙述, 故事, 家属, 亲戚; [计] 关系 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abstraction belonging to or characteristic of two entities or parts together; n. an act of narration; n. ...
measure 'meʒə POS: n	n. 尺寸, 量度器, 量度标准, 测量, 量具, 程度, 范围, 限度, 分寸, 措施, 方法; vt. 测量, 测度, 估量, 权衡, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any maneuver made as part of progress toward a goal; n. how much there is or how many there are of somethin...
involved ɪn'vɒlvd POS: a	a. 难懂的, 复杂的, 不易懂的, 卷入...之中的, 累及..., 与...有关, 被纠缠的; [计] 包含, 涉及 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. connected by participation or association or use; s. entangled or hindered as if e.g. in mire; s. emotional...
communication kə'mju:nɪ'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 交流, 交通, 通讯; [计] 通信 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of communicating; the activity of conveying information; n. something that is communicated by...
front frʌnt POS: n	n. 前面, 开头, 前线, 阵线, 态度; vt. 面对, 朝向, 对抗; vi. 朝向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the side that is forward or prominent; n. the outward appearance of a person; n. the side that is seen or th...
status 'steɪtəs POS: n	n. 状态, 情形, 地位, 要人身份; [计] 状态 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relative position or standing of things or especially persons in a society
confirm kən'fɜ:m POS: vt	vt. 证实, 确定, 批准, 使巩固; [计] 确认 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. establish or strengthen as with new evidence or facts; v. strengthen or make more firm; v. make more firm; v. ...
apparently ə'pæərəntli POS: adv	adv. 表面上, 清楚地, 显然地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. from appearances alone
crowd kraʊd POS: n	n. 群众, 一伙人; vt. 拥挤, 挤满, 挤进 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a large number of things or people considered together; n. an informal body of friends; v. fill or occupy to...
household 'haʊshəʊld POS: n	n. 一家人, 家庭, 家族, 王室; a. 家庭的, 家常的, 王室的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a social unit living together
dependent dɪ'pendənt POS: n	n. 依赖他人者; a. 依赖的, 从属的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relying on or requiring a person or thing for support, supply, or what is needed; s. contingent on somethin...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
clothing 'kleuðɪŋ POS: n	n. 衣服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a covering designed to be worn on a person's body
encounter in'kauntə POS: n	n. 相会, 相遇, 遭遇; vt. 遇见, 邂逅, 会战; vi. 偶然相遇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a casual meeting with a person or thing
reliable ri'laɪəbl POS: a	a. 可靠的, 可信赖的; [法] 可靠的, 可信赖的, 确实的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. worthy of reliance or trust
attendance ə'tendəns POS: n	n. 出席, 出席的人数, 照料; [法] 管理, 照料, 资助 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of being present (at a meeting or event etc.); n. the frequency with which a person is present; n. t...
southwest sauθ'west POS: n	n. 西南, 西南方, 西南地区; a. 西南的, 来自西南方的; adv. 往西南, 来自西南 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the compass point midway between south and west; at 225 degrees; n. the southwestern region of the United S...
isolate 'aɪsəleɪt POS: vt	vt. 使隔离, 使孤立, 使绝缘; n. 隔离种群 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. place or set apart; v. obtain in pure form; v. separate (experiences) from the emotions relating to them
clash klæʃ POS: n	n. 冲突, 撞击声, 抵触; vi. 冲突, 抵触; vt. 使发出撞击声; [计] 对撞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of conflict between persons; n. a state of conflict between colors; v. be incompatible; be or come i...
gathering 'gæðərɪŋ POS: n	n. 聚集, 集中, 采集; [化] 富集 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of persons together in one place
pillow 'pɪləʊ POS: n	n. 枕头, 靠垫, 枕状岩; vt. 作...的枕头, 垫, 枕于; vi. 靠在枕上 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cushion to support the head of a sleeping person; v. rest on or as if on a pillow
verbal 'vɜ:bl POS: a	a. 用言辞的, 言语的, 口头的, 逐字的, 动词的; [医] 言语的, 口述的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. communicated in the form of words; a. of or relating to or formed from words in general; a. of or relating t...
parental pe'rentəl POS: a	a. 父母亲的, 做双亲的, 作为渊源的; [医] 父母的, 双亲的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. designating the generation of organisms from which hybrid offspring are produced; a. relating to or charact...
utilize 'ju:taɪlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 利用 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. convert (from an investment trust to a unit trust)
pin pɪn POS: n	n. 大头针, 针, 别针, 栓, 销子, 图钉, 插头, 脚脚, 品(液量单位); vt. 将...用针别住, 钉住, 压住, 牵制, 使... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of jewelry that is pinned onto the wearer's garment; n. informal terms for the leg; n. cylindrical t...
pencil 'pensl POS: n	n. 铅笔, 色笔, 眉笔, 画笔, 光线束; vt. 用铅笔写或涂, 草拟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a thin cylindrical pointed writing implement; a rod of marking substance encased in wood; n. graphite (or a...
retreat ri'tri:t POS: n	n. 休息寓所, 撤退, 隐居, 退避; vi. 撤退, 隐退, 向后倾; vt. 退(棋) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (military) withdrawal of troops to a more favorable position to escape the enemy's superior forces or afte...
herd hɜ:d POS: n	n. 兽群, 人群, 牧人; vt. 群集, 使成群, 放牧; vi. 聚在一起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of cattle or sheep or other domestic mammals all of the same kind that are herded by humans; n. a g...
skinny 'skɪni POS: a	a. 似皮的, 极瘦的, 少的, 小气的; [医] 皮的; 消瘦的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. confidential information about a topic or person; a. of or relating to or resembling skin
sadness 'sædnɪs POS: n	n. 悲哀, 悲伤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. emotions experienced when not in a state of well-being; n. the state of being sad
enthusiast in'θju:ziæst POS: n	n. 热心家, 狂热者, 爱好者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an ardent and enthusiastic supporter of some person or activity
violin ,vaɪə'lin POS: n	n. 小提琴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. bowed stringed instrument that is the highest member of the violin family; this instrument has four string...
conjunction kən'dʒʌŋkʃən POS: n	n. 连接词, 联合, 结合; [计] 合取 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an uninflected function word that serves to conjoin words or phrases or clauses or sentences; n. the gramma...
nude nju:d POS: a	a. 裸的, 肉色的, 无装饰的; n. 裸体画, 裸体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a painting of a naked human figure; n. without clothing (especially in the phrase `in the nude'); n. a naked...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
singular 'singjʊlə POS: n	n. 单数; a. 异常的, 单一的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the form of a word that is used to denote a singleton; s. being a single and separate person or thing; a. co...
dialog 'daɪələg POS: n	n. 会话, 对话; [计] 对话 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a conversation between two persons; n. the lines spoken by characters in drama or fiction; n. a literary compos...
calculating 'kælkjuleɪtɪŋ POS: a	a. 计算的, (贬) 专为自己打算的, 深谋远虑的; [计] 计算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. used of persons